

Project Title: Point of Sale (POS) Hardware Upgrade: Bixolon to Star Thermal Receipt Printer Migration and Configuration

1. Project Objective:

- * Purpose: To restore and upgrade critical printing functionality for the Airport Taxi Booth by replacing a non-functional or outdated Bixolon receipt printer with a new Star Micro TSP Thermal printer.
- * Problem Solved: Addressed the inability to print customer receipts due to a faulty Bixolon printer, which directly impacted transaction processing and customer service. The migration to a Star Thermal printer provided a reliable and current printing solution.

2. Tools & Technologies Used:

- * Operating System: Windows 11 Desktop PC (connected to the POS system).
- * New Hardware: Star Micro TSP Thermal Receipt Printer.
- * Old Hardware: Bixolon Receipt Printer.
- * Cables: USB cable (for Star printer), power cable.
- * Software: Specific printer drivers for the Star Micro TSP Thermal, Windows Print Management, Device Manager.
- * Location: Airport Taxi Booth.

3. Detailed Steps Performed:

- * A. Initial Assessment & Preparation:
 - * "Responded to a service request concerning a non-functional Bixolon receipt printer at the Airport Taxi Booth."
 - * "Unboxed the new Star Micro TSP Thermal printer, ensuring all accessories, including cables and power supply, were present."
 - * "Noted the serial number of the new Star printer for inventory tracking purposes."
- * B. Disconnecting & Removing Old Printer:
 - * "Safely powered down the old Bixolon receipt printer and the connected point-of-sale (POS) system/computer."
 - * "Carefully disconnected all cables (power, data) from the old Bixolon printer."
 - * "Physically removed the old Bixolon printer from its location at the taxi booth."
 - * "Documented the serial number and asset tag of the old Bixolon printer for proper decommissioning and return procedures, ensuring accurate asset disposition."
- * C. Installing New Printer (Star Micro TSP Thermal):
 - * "Positioned the new Star Micro TSP Thermal printer in the designated location at the Airport Taxi Booth, ensuring stability and accessibility."
 - * "Connected the appropriate data cable (e.g., 'the USB cable from the printer to an available USB port on the POS computer') and the power cable to the new printer, connecting it to a power outlet."

- * "Powered on the new Star Micro TSP Thermal printer."
- * D. Driver Installation & Configuration:
 - * "Powered on the POS computer/workstation (Windows 11 Desktop PC)."
 - * "Accessed Windows Device Manager to confirm the new Star printer was detected as an unknown device or with a generic driver."
 - * "Installed the official Star Micro TSP Thermal printer drivers from [e.g., the manufacturer's website, a shared network drive with approved drivers, or an included driver disc/USB], following the installation wizard prompts."
 - * "Accessed Windows Print Management (or 'Devices and Printers') and verified that the Star Micro TSP Thermal printer was now correctly listed with its dedicated drivers."
 - * "Removed any remnants of the old Bixolon printer drivers or entries from Print Management to prevent conflicts."
 - * "Set the Star Micro TSP Thermal printer as the default printer for the POS application and the system, if it wasn't automatically configured."
 - * "Adjusted any necessary printer properties (e.g., paper size, print quality, cash drawer settings if integrated) within the printer's preferences to match operational requirements."
- * E. Functional Testing & Verification:
 - * "Performed a test print directly from Windows (e.g., 'Print Test Page' from Printer Properties) to confirm basic driver communication and paper feeding."
 - * "Launched the specific POS application used at the Airport Taxi Booth."
 - * "Conducted a live test by processing a dummy transaction to verify successful receipt printing from the POS software."
 - * "Confirmed print quality, alignment, and proper paper feeding from the new Star printer."
 - * "Obtained final confirmation from booth staff that the printer was fully functional, integrated with their application, and met all operational requirements."

4. Outcome & Impact:

* "Successfully migrated the Airport Taxi Booth's printing system from a faulty Bixolon printer to a new, fully functional Star Micro TSP Thermal printer, restoring critical point-of-sale functionality."

* "Ensured uninterrupted transaction processing and customer service by providing reliable receipt printing, supporting continuous business operations."

* "Demonstrated proficiency in specialized hardware replacement, precise driver installation and configuration for different manufacturers, and ensuring peripheral readiness in a production environment."

5. Skills Demonstrated:

- * Specialized Hardware Installation & Replacement (POS Printers)
- * Printer Driver Installation & Management
- * Windows Print Management
- * Point of Sale (POS) System Support (Peripheral Integration)
- * Hardware Troubleshooting (diagnosing the old printer's fault)
- * Functional Testing & Quality Assurance
- * Problem Resolution (restoring a broken service)
- * IT Asset Management (decommissioning old hardware)
- * Attention to Detail
- * User Support